

Using American Indian & Alaska Native Census Data

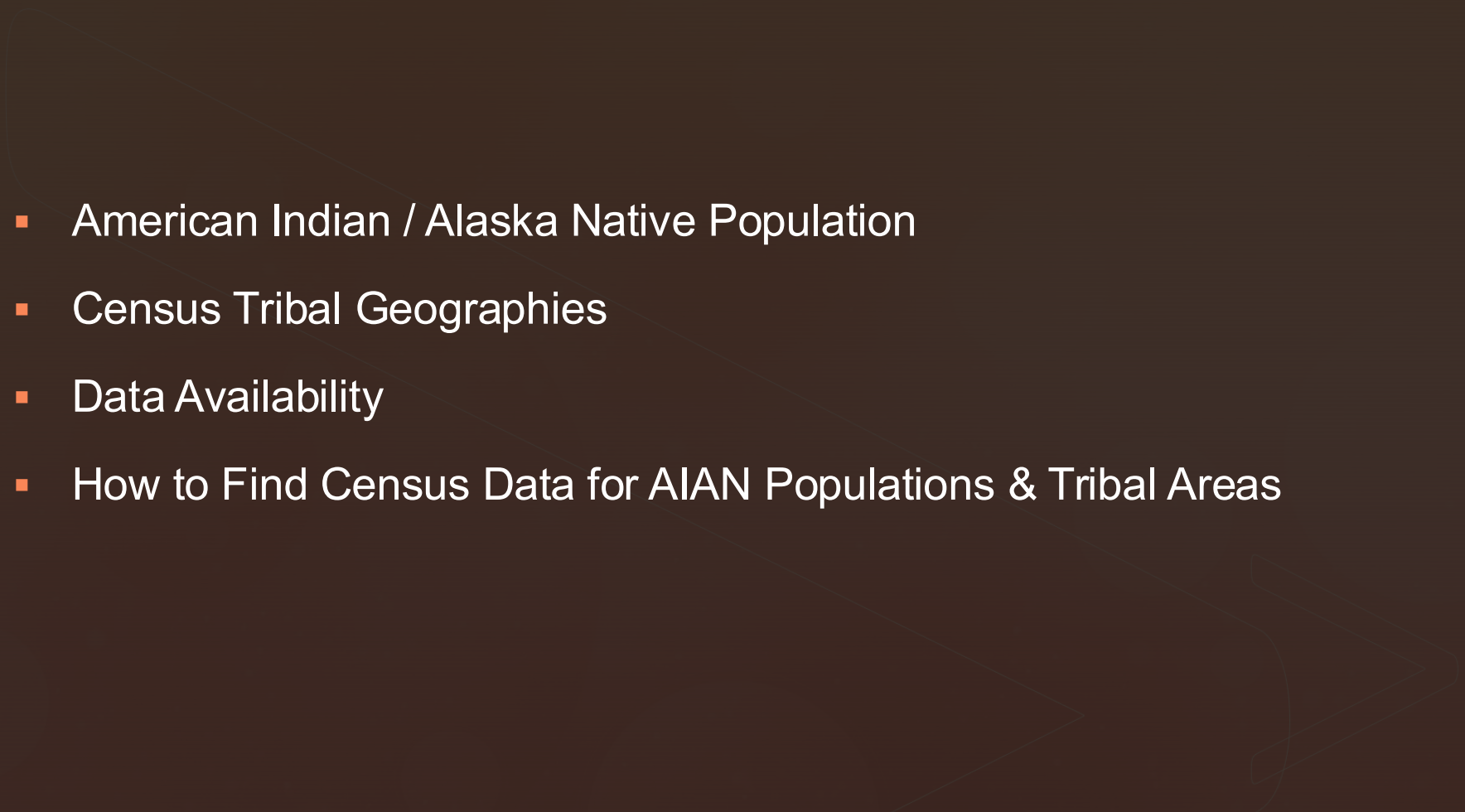
Data Club: Oct 30th, 2025

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Outline

- American Indian / Alaska Native Population
 - Census Tribal Geographies
 - Data Availability
 - How to Find Census Data for AIAN Populations & Tribal Areas
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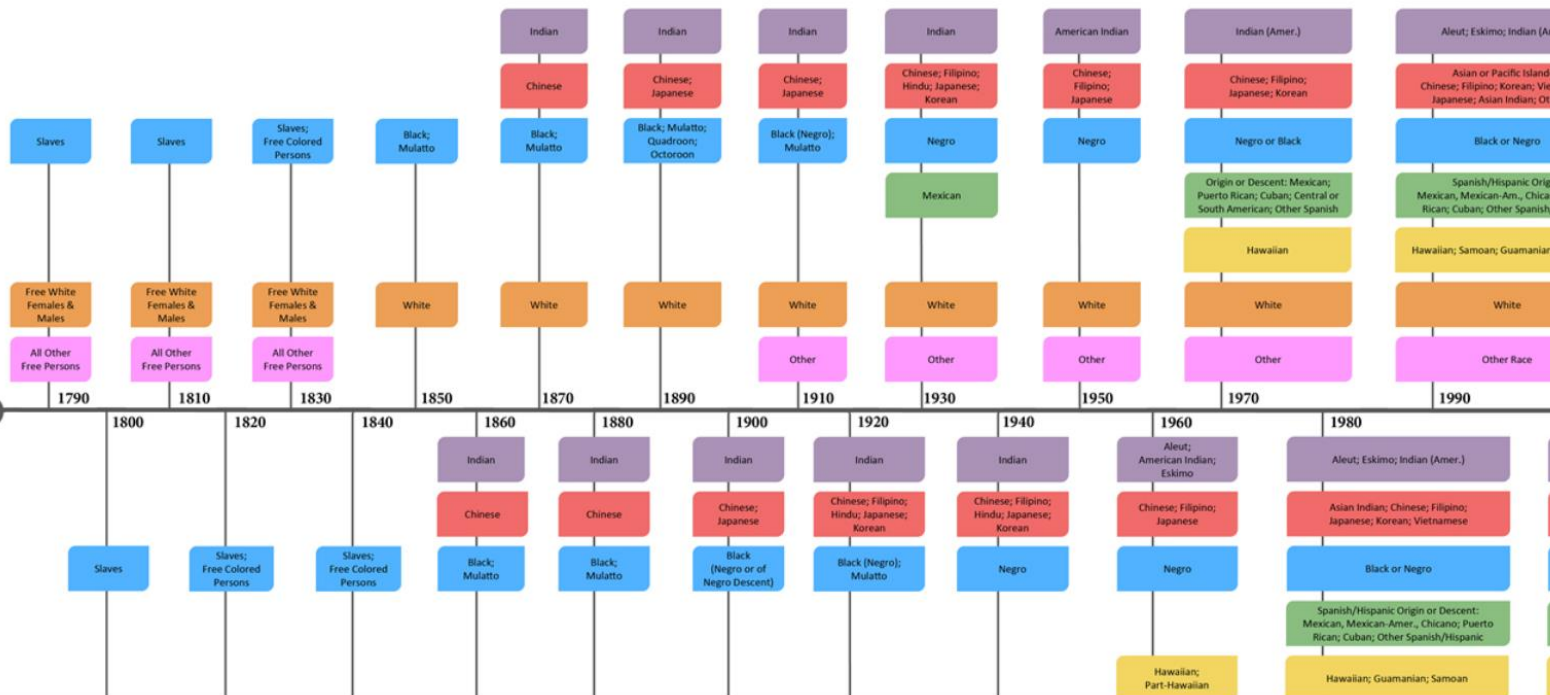
American Indian or Alaska Native

A person having origins in any of the original peoples of North and South America (including Central America) and who maintains tribal affiliation or community attachment. This category includes people who indicate their race as “American Indian or Alaska Native” or report entries such as Navajo Nation, Blackfeet Tribe, Mayan, Aztec, Native Village of Barrow Inupiat Traditional Government, or Nome Eskimo Community. Respondents who identified themselves as “American Indian or Alaska Native” were asked to report their enrolled or principal tribe. Therefore, tribal data in tabulations reflect the entries reported on the questionnaires. Some of the entries (for example, Metlakatla Indian Community and Umatilla) represent reservations or a confederation of tribes on a reservation.

Source: 2024 Subject Definitions

Definitions Change

Measuring Race and Ethnicity Across the Decades: 1790–2010
Mapped to 1997 U.S. Office of Management and Budget Classification Standards



1860: In 1860, census takers were instructed to enumerate only American Indians who were taxed. Taxed American Indians were those who had renounced tribal rule and exercised the rights of citizens under state or territorial laws. This primarily included American Indians who had settled in or near White communities and who had assimilated into American society. American Indians not taxed were considered to be those who lived among their kinsmen in tribal communities.

The racial category of “Chinese” was included on the 1860 Census questionnaire in California only.

Source: https://www.census.gov/data-tools/demo/race/MREAD_1790_2010.html

American Community Survey (ACS) Data Collection

- Office of Management & Budget defines race and ethnicity as two separate concepts.
- American Indian or Alaska Native** - A person having origins in any of the original peoples of North and South America (including Central America), and who maintains tribal affiliation or community attachment. People may identify with one or more race groups
- Asian** - A person having origins in any of the original peoples of the Far East, Southeast Asia, or the Indian subcontinent including, for example, Cambodia, China, India, Japan, Korea, Malaysia, Pakistan, the Philippine Islands, Thailand, and Vietnam.
- Black or African American** - A person having origins in any of the black racial groups of Africa.
- Hispanic or Latino** - A person of Cuban, Mexican, Puerto Rican, South or Central American, or other Spanish culture or origin, regardless of race.
- Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander** - A person having origins in any of the original peoples of Hawaii, Guam, Samoa, or other Pacific Islands.
- White** - A person having origins in any of the original peoples of Europe, the Middle East, or North Africa.
- The Census Bureau is also permitted to use the category **“Some Other Race”**

→ **NOTE:** Please answer **BOTH** Question 5 about Hispanic origin and Question 6 about race. For this survey, Hispanic origins are not races.

5 Is Person 1 of Hispanic, Latino, or Spanish origin?

- ☐ No, not of Hispanic, Latino, or Spanish origin
- ☐ Yes, Mexican, Mexican Am., Chicano
- ☐ Yes, Puerto Rican
- ☐ Yes, Cuban
- ☐ Yes, another Hispanic, Latino, or Spanish origin – *Print origin, for example, Argentinean, Colombian, Dominican, Nicaraguan, Salvadoran, Spaniard, and so on.*

6 What is Person 1's race?

Mark (X) one or more boxes **AND** print origins.

- ☐ White – *Print, for example, German, Irish, English, Italian, Lebanese, Egyptian, etc.*

- ☐ Black or African Am. – *Print, for example, African American, Jamaican, Haitian, Nigerian, Ethiopian, Somali, etc.*

- ☐ American Indian or Alaska Native – *Print name of enrolled or principal tribe(s), for example, Navajo Nation, Blackfeet Tribe, Mayan, Aztec, Native Village of Barrow Inupiat Traditional Government, Nome Eskimo Community, etc.*

- | | | |
|---|--|--|
| ☐ Chinese | ☐ Vietnamese | ☐ Native Hawaiian |
| ☐ Filipino | ☐ Korean | ☐ Samoan |
| ☐ Asian Indian | ☐ Japanese | ☐ Chamorro |
| ☐ Other Asian – <i>Print, for example, Pakistani, Cambodian, Hmong, etc.</i> | ☐ Other Pacific Islander – <i>Print, for example, Tongan, Fijian, Marshallese, etc.</i> | |

- ☐ Some other race – *Print race or origin.*

ACS & AIAN Data Collection

Self-response

- Indicate their race as “American Indian or Alaska Native”
- Asked to report the name of their enrolled or principal tribe
- Report the name of their Indian group

Special procedures exist to increase the sampling rates for AIAN Areas:

- Higher overall sample size to help with higher quality data over smaller geographic areas
- Attempting a personal visit interview for all cases in most American Indian and Alaska Native Areas, compared to most areas of the country which attempt to follow-up with only a sample of eligible cases

6 What is Person 1's race?
Mark (X) one or more boxes **AND** print origins.

☐ White – Print, for example, German, Irish, English, Italian, Lebanese, Egyptian, etc. 

☐ Black or African Am. – Print, for example, African American, Jamaican, Haitian, Nigerian, Ethiopian, Somali, etc. 

☐ American Indian or Alaska Native – Print name of enrolled or principal tribe(s), for example, Navajo Nation, Blackfeet Tribe, Mayan, Aztec, Native Village of Barrow Inupiat Traditional Government, Nome Eskimo Community, etc. 

☐ Chinese ☐ Vietnamese ☐ Native Hawaiian

☐ Filipino ☐ Korean ☐ Samoan

☐ Asian Indian ☐ Japanese ☐ Chamorro

☐ Other Asian – Print, for example, Pakistani, Cambodian, Hmong, etc. 

☐ Other Pacific Islander – Print, for example, Tongan, Fijian, Marshallese, etc. 

☐ Some other race – Print race or origin. 

What Topics Are Available in the ACS?

Social (DP02)

- ✓ Ancestry
- ✓ Citizenship Status
- ✓ Disability Status
- ✓ Educational Attainment & School Enrollment
- ✓ Fertility
- ✓ Grandparents as Caregivers
- ✓ Language Spoken at Home
- ✓ Marital History; Marital Status
- ✓ Migration/Residence 1 Year Ago
- ✓ Period of Military Service
- ✓ Place of Birth
- ✓ Undergraduate Field of Degree
- ✓ Veteran Status
- ✓ Year of Entry

Economic (DP03)

- ✓ Income
- ✓ Benefits
- ✓ Employment Status
- ✓ Occupation
- ✓ Industry
- ✓ Commuting to Work
- ✓ Place of Work

Housing (DP04)

- ✓ Tenure
- ✓ Housing Value
- ✓ Occupancy
- ✓ Taxes and Insurance
- ✓ Household Size
- ✓ Utilities

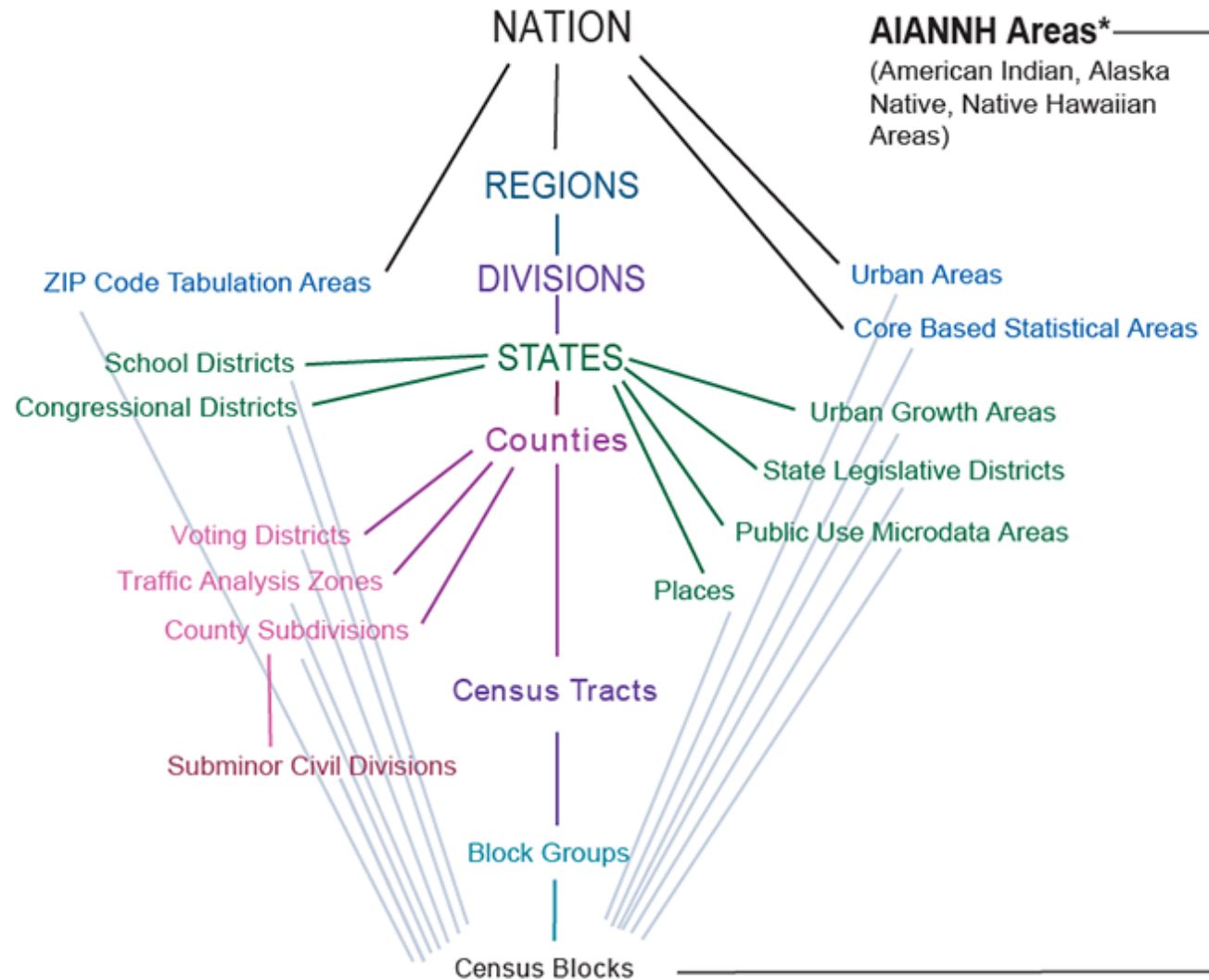
Demographic (DP05)

- ✓ Age
- ✓ Race
- ✓ Hispanic Origin
- ✓ Sex

What topics can you get from the 2020 Census?

- ✓ Age
- ✓ Race
- ✓ Sex
- ✓ Hispanic or Latino Origin
- ✓ Household Relationship
- ✓ Tenure (Owned vs. Rented)
- ✓ Vacancy Characteristics

Standard Hierarchy of Census Geographic Entities



Census Geographies

- Census Tracts
 - 1,200 to 8,000 population (optimum 4,000)
 - 480 to 3,200 housing units
- Census Block Groups
 - 600 to 3,000 population
 - 240 to 1,200 housing units
- Blocks are not defined by population and are the smallest geographic level at which data are ever released (Decennial Census, not the ACS)

American Indians and Alaska Natives in the United States



Percent Distribution of the American Indian and Alaska Native Population by American Indian/Alaska Native Area of Residence: 2020

American Indian and Alaska Native Area of Residence	Percent of American Indian and Alaska Native Population
American Indian and Alaska Native alone	24.2
Alaska Native Village Statistical Area	1.5
Outside of American Indian and Alaska Native Area	74.3
American Indian and Alaska Native in combination	4.9
American Indian and Alaska Native alone or in combination	29.1
American Indian and Alaska Native alone or in combination	44.8

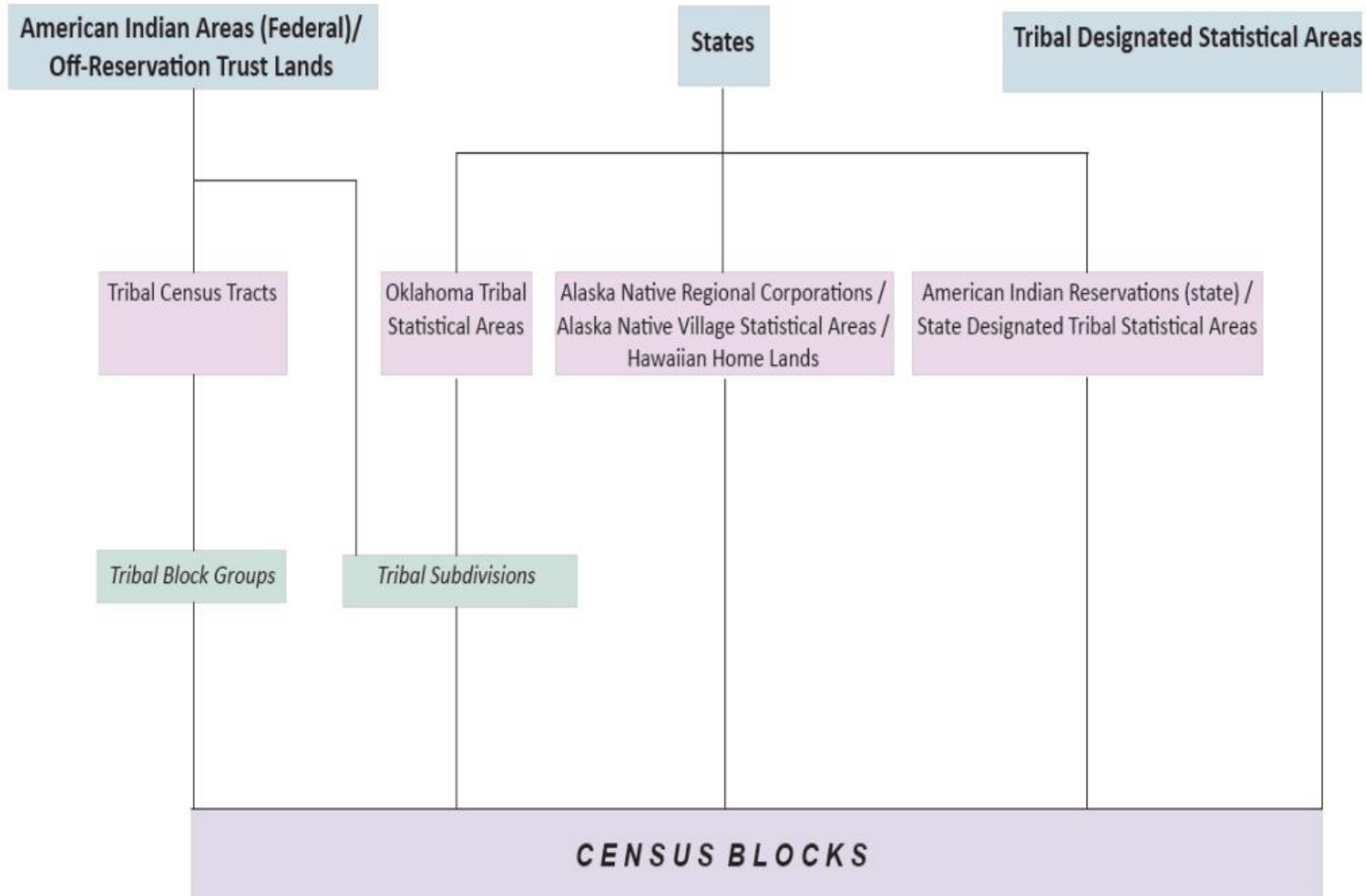


American Indian and Alaska Native in Combination Population: 2010 and 2020

American Indian and Alaska Native in Combination	2010	2020
American Indian and Alaska Native alone	1,422,008	1,544,099
American Indian and Alaska Native alone and American Indian and Alaska Native alone	445,187	570,701
American Indian and Alaska Native alone or in combination	1,867,195	2,114,800
American Indian and Alaska Native alone or in combination	1,867,195	2,114,800

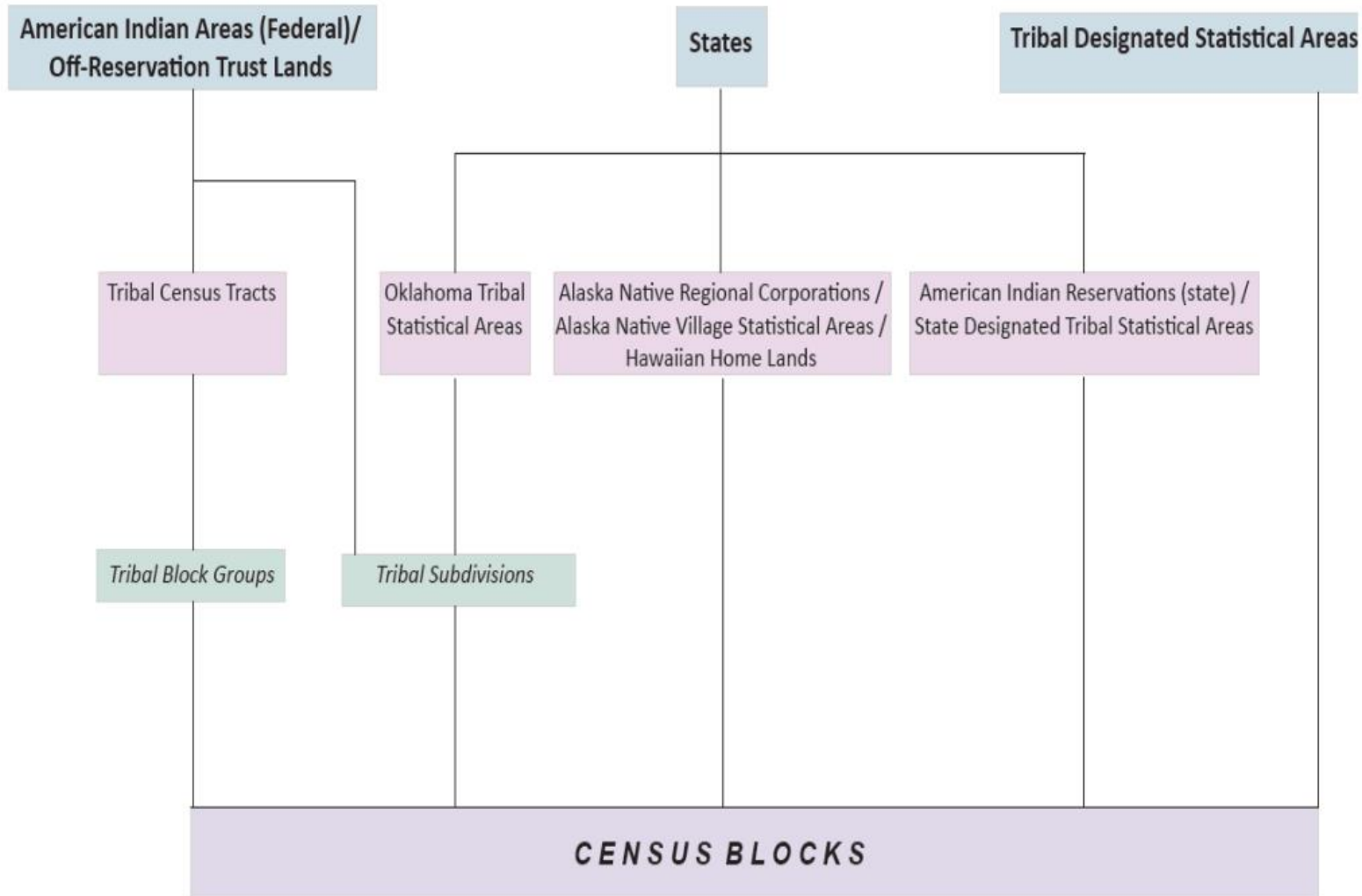
- Legend**
- American Indian Reservation and/or Off-Reservation Trust Land (Federal)
 - Oklahoma Tribal Statistical Area
 - Tribal Designated Statistical Area
 - American Indian Reservation (State)
 - State Designated Tribal Statistical Area
 - Alaska Native Regional Corporation

Tribal Geographies



- The Census Bureau maintains government-to-government relationships with 574 federally recognized tribes
- Data collection covers 326 federal and state reservations and other tribal areas
- Introduced in 2000, although reworked in 2010

Tribal Geographies

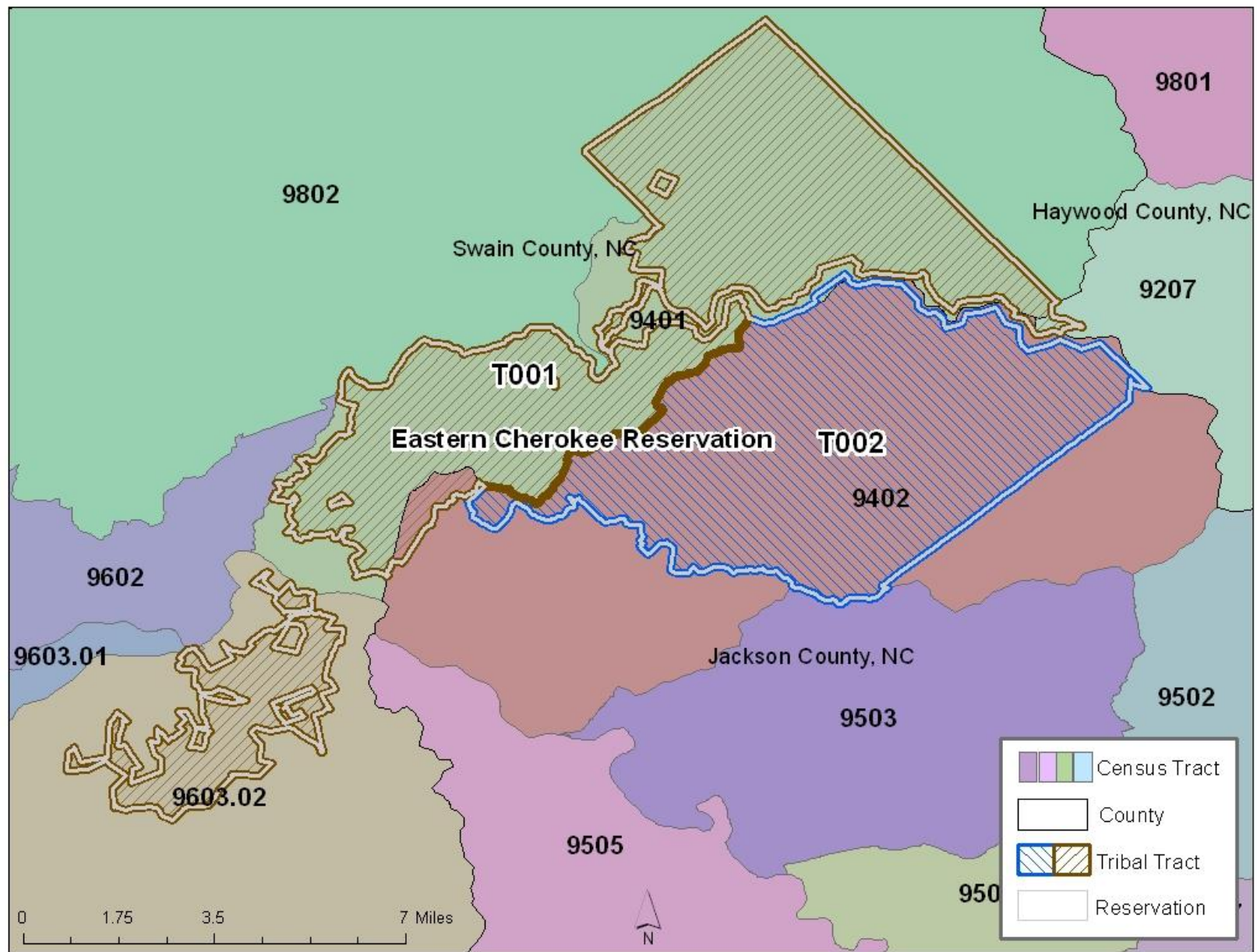


Legal Entities

- Federally recognized American Indian reservations and off-reservation trust land areas
- State-recognized American Indian reservations
- Alaska Native Regional Corporations
- Hawaiian homelands
- Tribal subdivisions that can divide these entities

Statistical Entities

- Alaska Native village statistical areas
- Oklahoma tribal statistical areas
- Tribal designated statistical areas
- State designated tribal statistical areas



Tract Comparison

State-County Census Tracts	Tribal Census Tracts
Unique to and nested within the <u>county</u>	Unique to and nested within the <u>Reservation</u>
	Can cross state and county lines
	Can be discontinuous
Numeric 6 digit name (e.g. 304200, 180102)	Name starts with a 'T' (e.g. T001, T002)
Cover the entire U.S.	Cover only Federally-recognized American Indian Areas with land

Census Tools With AIAN Data

	Tribal Area	AIAN Population
<u>Census Business Builder</u>		Y
<u>Census Survey Explorer</u>	Y	Y
<u>TIGERweb</u>	Y	Y
<u>Explore Census Data</u>	Y	Y
<u>Longitudinal Employer- Household Dynamics (LEHD)</u>		Y
<u>My Community Explorer</u>		Y
<u>My Tribal Area</u>	Y	Y
QuickFacts (under maintenance)		Y
<u>ACS Narrative Profiles</u>	Y	Y

New York Federal Statistical Research Data Center (NYRDC)

- FSRDCs provide secure environments supporting qualified researchers using restricted-access data while protecting respondent confidentiality. These restricted-access data come from censuses and surveys of businesses and households, linked employer-employee data, and administrative records from federal and state agencies and other sources.
- For restricted level access to data visit <https://www.census.gov/about/adrm/fsrdc.html>
- [ResearchDataGov](#) offers additional information about data available through the FSRDCs.
- Prospective researchers can learn more about the research that can be done using Census data by browsing the [Center for Economic Studies \(CES\) Working Paper Series](#). This includes a list of publications that resulted from RDC projects since 2019 as well as abstracts of active and completed RDC projects.



Accessing the Data

- My Tribal Area
- ~~Explore Census Data (data.census.gov)~~
- IPUMS / NHGIS

Finding Data

- My Tribal Area:
<https://www.census.gov/tribal>
- ACS 5 Year Estimates
- Contains a glossary for geographic areas



The screenshot shows the 'My Tribal Area' web application. The title 'My Tribal Area' is at the top in large blue font. Below it is a search bar with the placeholder 'Enter name of Tribal Area'. To the right of the search bar are five icons: 'People' (three figures), 'Jobs' (briefcase), 'Housing' (house), 'Economy' (dollar sign), and 'Education' (graduation cap). Below the search bar is the word 'OR' and two dropdown menus. The first dropdown is labeled '1 Select a State' and the second is labeled '2'. To the left of the dropdowns is a yellow map of the United States. To the right of the map is a text box with the following content: 'The Census Bureau collects data for the American Indian and Alaska Native (AIAN) population and publishes specific counts, estimates, and statistics. My Tribal Area gives you quick and easy access to selected statistics from the [American Community Survey \(ACS\)](#). The ACS provides detailed demographic, social, economic, and housing statistics every year for the nation's communities. My Tribal Area is powered by the [Census Application Programming Interface \(API\)](#). Users should exercise caution when comparing 2019-2023 ACS 5-year estimates to other ACS estimates. For more information, please visit the [2023 ACS 5-year Comparison Guidance page](#). **Source: 2019-2023 American Community Survey 5-Year Estimates**'. At the bottom left is the 'U.S. Census Bureau' logo and the text 'U.S. Department of Commerce U.S. CENSUS BUREAU census.gov'. At the bottom center is the text 'POWERED BY The American Community Survey'. At the bottom right is a link to the 'Glossary'.

My Tribal Area

Enter name of Tribal Area

OR

1. Washington

2. Puyallup Reservation and Off-Reservation



About the map



Puyallup Reservation and Off-Reservation Trust Land, WA

Source: 2019-2023 American Community Survey 5-Year Estimates

Sex and Age	Estimate	ACS Margin of Error
Total population	55,481	(+/-1,587)
Male	27,851	(+/-1,042)
Female	27,630	(+/-915)
Under 5 years	3,535	(+/-428)
5 to 9 years	4,050	(+/-400)
10 to 14 years	3,832	(+/-467)
15 to 19 years	3,585	(+/-337)
20 to 24 years	2,690	(+/-374)
25 to 34 years	8,924	(+/-582)
35 to 44 years	8,225	(+/-547)
45 to 54 years	6,708	(+/-467)
55 to 59 years	3,218	(+/-290)
60 to 64 years	3,453	(+/-382)
65 to 74 years	4,578	(+/-436)

☒ Display ACS Margin of Error

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The American Community Survey

Glossary

IPUMS provides census and survey data from around the world integrated across time and space. IPUMS integration and documentation makes it easy to study change, conduct comparative research, merge information across data types, and analyze individuals within family and community contexts. Data and services available free of charge.



U.S. Census and American Community Survey microdata from 1850 to the present. [Learn More](#)

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Current Population Survey microdata including basic monthly surveys and supplements from 1962 to the present. [Learn More](#)

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World's largest collection of census microdata covering over 100 countries, contemporary and historical. [Learn More](#)

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U.S. Census summary tables and GIS data from 1790 to the present. [Learn More](#)

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Summary tables and GIS data from population, housing, and agricultural censuses around the world. [Learn More](#)

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GEOGRAPHIC LEVEL DETAILS

Level: Tribal Census Tract (by American Indian Area/Alaska Native Area/Hawaiian Home Land)

Unit class: TRIBAL CENSUS TRACT

NHGIS ID: trbl_ct

NHGIS Code: 256

Years for which *GIS files* are available:

2010, 2011, 2012, 2013, 2014, 2015, 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023

Number of *time series tables* for this level: 0

Datasets with *source tables* for this level:

Group	Code	Dataset
2000 Census	2000_SF1a	SF 1a - 100% Data [Areas Larger Than Block Groups]
	2000_SF2	SF 2 - 100% Data with Race/Ethnicity Breakdown
	2000_SF3a	SF 3a - Sample-Based Data [Areas Larger Than Block Groups]
	2000_SF4	SF 4 - Sample-Based Data with Race/Ethnicity Breakdown
2010 American Community Survey	2006_2010_ACS5a	5-Year Data [2006-2010, Block Groups & Larger Areas]
	2006_2010_ACS5b	5-Year Data [2006-2010, Tracts & Larger Areas]
2010 Census	2010_SF1a	SF 1a - P & H Tables [Blocks & Larger Areas]
	2010_SF1b	SF 1b - PCT & HCT Tables [Tracts & Larger Areas]

YEARS



Dimmed choices are not available given your other filter selections.

DECENNIAL CENSUS YEARS

- ☐ 2020
- ☐ 2010
- ☐ 2000
- ☐ 1990
- ☐ 1980
- ☐ 1970
- ☐ 1960
- ☐ 1950
- ☐ 1940
- ☐ 1930
- ☐ 1920
- ☐ 1910
- ☐ 1900
- ☐ 1890
- ☐ 1880
- ☐ 1870
- ☐ 1860
- ☐ 1850

NON-DECENNIAL YEARS

- | | | | |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| ☐ 2023 | ☐ 1988 | ☐ 1955 | ☐ 1922 |
| ☐ 2022 | ☐ 1987 | ☐ 1954 | ☐ 1921 |
| ☐ 2021 | ☐ 1986 | ☐ 1953 | ☐ 1919 |
| ☐ 2019 | ☐ 1985 | ☐ 1952 | ☐ 1918 |
| ☐ 2018 | ☐ 1984 | ☐ 1951 | ☐ 1917 |
| ☐ 2017 | ☐ 1983 | ☐ 1949 | ☐ 1916 |
| ☐ 2016 | ☐ 1982 | ☐ 1948 | ☐ 1915 |
| ☐ 2015 | ☐ 1981 | ☐ 1947 | ☐ 1906 |
| ☐ 2014 | ☐ 1979 | ☐ 1946 | ☐ 1886 |
| ☐ 2013 | ☐ 1978 | ☐ 1945 | ☐ 1885 |
| ☐ 2012 | ☐ 1977 | ☐ 1944 | ☐ 1884 |
| ☐ 2011 | ☐ 1976 | ☐ 1943 | ☐ 1883 |
| ☐ 2009 | ☐ 1975 | ☐ 1942 | ☐ 1882 |
| ☐ 2007 | ☐ 1974 | ☐ 1941 | ☐ 1881 |
| ☐ 2006 | ☐ 1973 | ☐ 1939 | ☐ 1879 |
| ☐ 2005 | ☐ 1972 | ☐ 1938 | ☐ 1878 |
| ☐ 2004 | ☐ 1971 | ☐ 1937 | ☐ 1877 |
| ☐ 2003 | ☐ 1969 | ☐ 1936 | ☐ 1876 |

ACS 5-YEAR PERIODS

- ☒ 2019-2023
- ☐ 2018-2022
- ☐ 2017-2021
- ☐ 2016-2020
- ☐ 2015-2019
- ☐ 2014-2018
- ☐ 2013-2017
- ☐ 2012-2016
- ☐ 2011-2015
- ☐ 2010-2014
- ☐ 2009-2013
- ☐ 2008-2012
- ☐ 2007-2011
- ☐ 2006-2010
- ☐ 2005-2009

ACS 3-YEAR PERIODS

- ☐ 2011-2013

CANCEL

SUBMIT